Anika Jain

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Mixed-methods UX Researcher focused on accessibility who blends deep research skills (user interviews, contextual inquiries, surveys, usability testing) with a software engineering background, bringing strengths in cross-functional collaboration, rapid prototyping, and systems thinking. Achievements include two published ACM CHI papers on generative AI usage, an AI buying agent for Consumer Reports, an ML-driven image analysis project at AWS, and an Android app for color-blind users with 10K+ downloads.

SKILLS

Research: User Interviews, Contextual Inquiries, Surveys, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Workshop Facilitation, Interaction Design
Tools: Figma, Dovetail, UserTesting, Dscout, Qualtrics, Prolific, Miro, Notion, Jira, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft Office Suite
Technical: Applied Machine Learning, AWS, Android, Database Design, Distributed Systems, Object-Oriented Analysis
Programming Languages: Java, Python, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL, C++

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz (UCSC) Santa Cruz, CA | Sep 2026 - Jun 2030 (expected)
Doctor of Philosophy in Computational Media

Carnegie Mellon University (CMU) Pittsburgh, PA | Aug 2024 - Aug 2025
Master of Human-Computer Interaction (GPA: 3.83/4.00)

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (UIUC) Urbana, IL | Aug 2021 - May 2024
Bachelor of Science with Honors in Computer Science + Astronomy (Dean's List x3, GPA: 3.80/4.00)

PUBLICATIONS

Qianou Ma, **Anika Jain**, Jini Kim, Megan Chai, and Geoff Kaufman. 2025. *ImaginAItion: Promoting Generative AI Literacy Through Game-Based Learning*. Proceedings of the Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25). https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3719844

Alex Atcheson, Omar Khan, Brian Siemann, **Anika Jain**, and Karrie Karahalios. *"I'd Never Actually Realized How Big An Impact It Had Until Now": Perspectives of University Students with Disabilities on Generative Artificial Intelligence.* Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (2025). https://doi.org/10.1145/3706598.3714121

WORK EXPERIENCE

Carnegie Mellon University (CMU) CyLab | *UI/UX Researcher* Cupertino, CA | Oct 2025 - Aug 2026

- Led end-to-end design of new IoT Assistant app and IoT Privacy Infrastructure features, including registry and resource creation, account management, and in-app filtering
- Translated complex backend engineering and legal requirements into intuitive flows for exercising CCPA and GDPR rights
- Piloted privacy infrastructure in smart city initiatives with the City of Long Beach and CSULB
- Designed and conducted mixed-methods user research studies evaluating user comprehension of evolving privacy regulations, culminating in a paper submitted for peer-reviewed publication

Carnegie Mellon University (CMU) | *Part-Time Research Assistant* Pittsburgh, PA | May 2025 - Sep 2025

- Built and productionized *EstiMate*, a web tool for *Product Management Essentials* students to explore product feature tradeoffs
- Transformed static workflow, with goal of reducing assignment time by 25% and enabling use beyond class for quick estimates
- Defined product behavior, learning goals, and information architecture via collaboration with professor and VP of Engineering
- Interviewed students, yielding insights on critical transparency gaps that led to significant restructuring of the course curriculum

Amazon Web Services (AWS) - IoT FleetWise | *Software Development Intern* Sunnyvale, CA | May 2023 - Aug 2023

- Built an ML-powered service to classify and blur items in cloud-based dashcam streams containing TBs of image data
- Developed configurable user controls for identifying and blurring objects, ensuring privacy-preserving data access
- Enabled integration and testing of customer ML models, aiding customers in analysis of performance and utility tradeoffs

UIUC Housing | *Resident Advisor* Urbana, IL | Aug 2022 - May 2023

- Fostered community among 50+ students through mentorship, 1:1s, and monthly hall programs on personal values
- Advised first-year students on academic and personal concerns while handling administrative duties such as incident reports

PROJECTS

Panetta Institute for Public Policy Research Program | *Research Fellow* Monterey Bay, CA | Aug 2026 - Present

- Semester-long fellowship studying U.S. policymaking via seminars by Secretary Leon Panetta and state policymakers
- Researching policy on AI regulation and reasonable accommodations evaluation under the Department of Labor, grounded in the legislative history of the ADA and WCAG accessibility standards
- Producing a formal policy paper and oral presentation, including nonpartisan analysis of party positions, legislative history, and policy alternatives

Best Time to Buy 2.0: Capstone with Consumer Reports (CR) | *Lead Researcher, Designer* Pittsburgh, PA | Jan 2025 - Jul 2025

- Led mixed-methods research to redesign 'Best Time to Buy' (a key benefit for CR's 6M+ users) as an AI-powered buying agent
- Orchestrated interviews, usability tests, and surveys with 172 participants, informing core principles for user trust in AI agents
- Synthesized findings into product recommendations and future-state timeline projected to generate $2M+ in revenue growth
- Secured stakeholder support by leading 2 co-design workshops as well as developing 10+ journey maps and process models

Spectra: Color-Blind Assistant | *Sole Developer, Designer, Researcher* Cupertino, CA | Jul 2019 - Sep 2021

- Created and published the Android app *Spectra: Color-Blind Assistant*, which has over 10,000 downloads
- Conducted optometrist interviews and 10+ user tests to refine algorithm functionality and improve overall app experience
- Developed novel algorithms for personalized real-time color enhancements and calibration of color blindness severities